



Google Stadia bad for Earth?

Google's Stadia is the future of gaming, and that's bad news for our planet.
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Intel expands portfolio

Intel expands 9th Gen core portfolio with new desktop CPUs including Core i9-9900KF.
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GALAX RTX 2080 Ti

The cheapest RTX 2080 Ti you can buy

GALAX had been missing from the graphics card market in India for quite some time. Their cards could sometimes be spotted on the shelves at Lamington Road but their online presence had completely trickled down. It now seems that they're back and they're wasting no time in making their presence felt across all ecommerce channels. The GALAX RTX 2080 Ti is the absolute basic RTX 2080 Ti from GALAX with none of the fancy lighting features or the heavy duty coolers. The RTX 2080 Ti continues to be the most expensive GPU and this SKU brings it within the reach of enthusiasts.

GALAX has a pretty wide portfolio of RTX 2080 Ti GPUs. While the GALAX RTX 2080 Ti sits at one end of the spectrum, the other end has the GALAX RTX 2080 Ti HOF (Hall of Fame Edition) which is the absolute best from GALAX's stables.

Features

Like all RTX 2080 Ti graphics cards, the GALAX RTX 2080 Ti supports Real-time Ray Tracing, Ansel, G-SYNC, GPU Boost and has the latest Turing Encoder which is much more efficient than the Volta encoder that's found in the previous gen cards. Since we're looking at a reference card, the Core clock sits at 1350 MHz and with Boost it can hit 1545 MHz. All other specifications such as the CUDA Cores, ROPs, TMUs remain the same since this is the exact same GPU. Coming to the connectors, it has 3x DisplayPorts, 1x HDMI port and 1x USB Type-C port for VirtualLink. VirtualLink has become a standard thanks to wide support from Industry giants such as NVIDIA, AMD, Microsoft, Valve, Oculus and HTC. Essentially, it's future VR-ready.

Build Quality

The GALAX RTX 2080 Ti reminds us of the old single-blower reference



Price
₹1,09,990



PERFORMANCE.....90
BUILD75
VALUE FOR MONEY....75

design used by NVIDIA with the GTX 680 and GTX 780, or for that matter, even the AMD RX VEGA64. In a way, this is a step down from the reference cooler design that's seen on the NVIDIA Founders Edition cards. FE cards have a twin blower design and most of the front as well as the back are covered with metal which adds to the durability. In the case of the GALAX RTX 2080 Ti, it makes use of a plastic shroud on the front and there is no backplate, plastic or metal. These cost saving measures allow GALAX to price the RTX 2080 Ti more aggressively.

Glancing at the rear of the PCB, we can say that it's more or the same as the Founders Edition design. The newer FE cards were ridiculously difficult to disassemble but that's not the case with the GALAX RTX 2080 Ti. Since this is the reference card in all likelihood, repairs should be way easier. Having looked at the heatsink for the GPU and the VRM, you're simply left with a feeling of deja vu as you'll have seen this configuration in the past. The last aspect is that of RGB. Thankfully, there isn't any of that nonsense which makes this all good in our books. For the power, the GALAX RTX 2080 Ti requires two 8-PIN power connectors which is again, the same as the FE.

Performance

We started off by running a couple of games at different resolutions. Far Cry

5 ran at 126 FPS on FHD, 118 on 1440p and about 77 FPS on 4K. With GTA V, FHD and 1440p seem to be fairly equal pointing to a fact that the card is a bit too powerful to use GTA V as

a benchmark game.

In The Witcher 3, we managed to get about 177 FPS on FHD, 131 FPS on 1440p and 79 FPS on 4K.. It seems that the RTX 2080 Ti beats all previous cards in practically every single

benchmark. Coming to the power consumption, the performance per watt ratio is particularly high as well. When we compare the performance-to-price ratio, we get the most

expensive card that has been released for gaming. Every other GPU offers a greater performance-price ratio making you wonder whether the RTX 2080 Ti is really worth it.

Conclusion

The GALAX RTX 2080 Ti is very much a reference RTX 2080 Ti but with a slightly scaled down cooler. It does run hotter than the FE as a result but not enough to cause any throttling. GALAX has made this particular card very competitive owing to some of the cost cutting measures taken. If enthusiast gamers were dissuaded from getting an RTX 2080 Ti in the past because of the high price, then that's not as big a concern since they now have a much more affordable card in the GALAX RTX 2080 Ti. All you now need is for more developers to make use of the real-time ray tracing features that form the cornerstone of this new GPU. We do hope that happens soon enough.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

CUDA CORES: 4352 | ROPS: 64 | CORE CLOCK: 1350 MHz | BOOST CLOCK: 1545 MHz | MEMORY CLOCK: 14 GHz | MEMORY BUS WIDTH: 256-bit | VRAM: 11 GB | TDP: 260 W | WARRANTY: 3 Years.

CONTACT

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